

SOFTWARE DEPLOYMENT, OPERATIONS AND MAINTENANCE FINAL PROJECT REPORT

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CHAPTER 1: OVERVIEW & SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

1.1 Project Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to design and operate a production-grade software delivery system that automates the path from source code modification to live production deployment. The system emphasizes security integration, container orchestration, persistent data management, and runtime observability, reflecting industry DevOps standards.

1.2 Selected Architecture Tier

The team selected **Tier 2: Single-Server Containerized Deployment**. This tier requires all application components to run inside Docker containers orchestrated by Docker Compose on a single Ubuntu cloud server. Tier 2 was chosen to balance architectural maturity with operational manageability while satisfying all mandatory requirements for multi-container separation, persistent storage, reverse proxy routing, and automated CI/CD integration.

1.3 Technology Stack

- **Application:** Node.js, Express.js, Multer (file uploads), MongoDB driver
- **Database:** MongoDB 6.0 (official Docker image)
- **Containerization:** Docker Engine, Docker Compose
- **Reverse Proxy:** Nginx Proxy Manager (containerized)
- **CI/CD:** GitHub Actions, Docker Hub, Trivy (security scanning)
- **Cloud Infrastructure:** AWS EC2 (Ubuntu 22.04 LTS)

- **Domain & HTTPS:** Hostinger domain, Let's Encrypt certificate
- **Monitoring:** Prometheus, Grafana, Node Exporter, cAdvisor

1.4 System Architecture Diagram

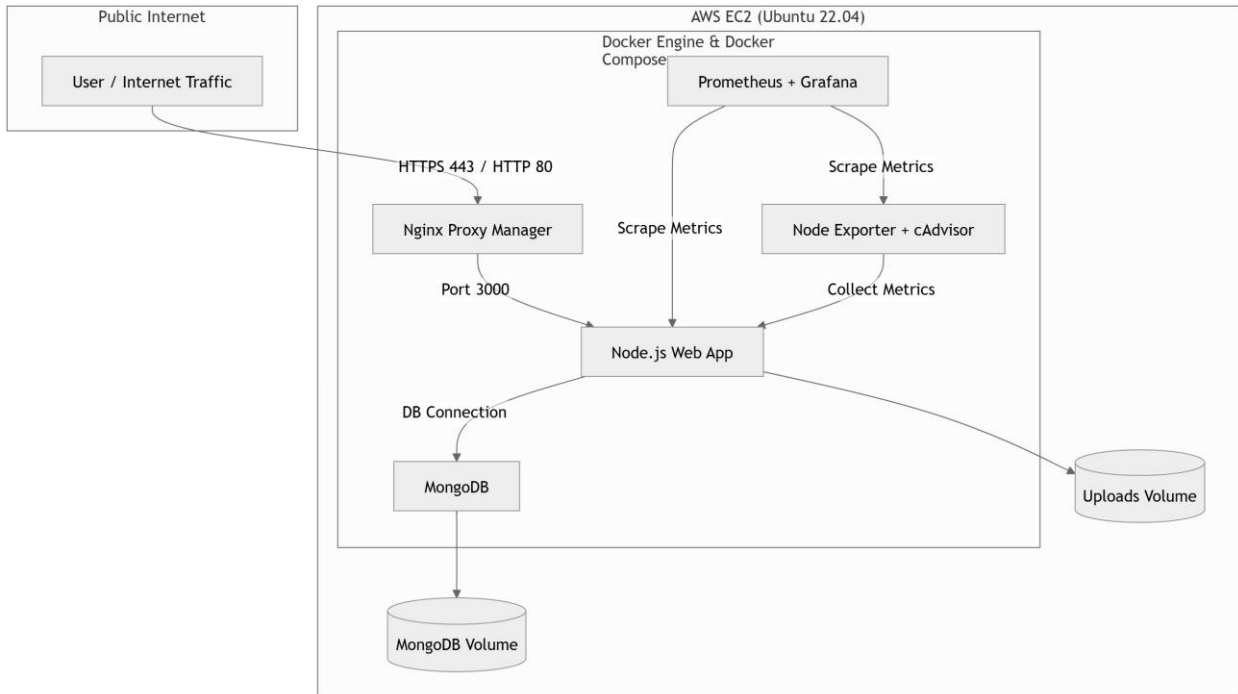


Figure 1.1: Tier 2 System Architecture

final-project-tier2 Public		Pin	Watch 0
main	1 Branch 0 Tags	Go to file	Add file Code
holeminh05	feat: add node-exporter and cadvisor for monitoring ✓	b0c714e · 1 hour ago	13 Commits
.github/workflows	Update ci-cd.yml	2 hours ago	
app	feat: add node-exporter and cadvisor for monitoring	1 hour ago	
monitoring	feat: add node-exporter and cadvisor for monitoring	1 hour ago	
.gitignore	feat: initialize Tier 2 app structure and docker-compose	3 hours ago	
README.md	Initial commit	3 hours ago	
docker-compose.yml	feat: add node-exporter and cadvisor for monitoring	1 hour ago	

Figure 1.2: Repository Structure Showing Multi-Container Application Organization

The diagram illustrates internet traffic routing through a registered domain to the AWS EC2 instance, where the Nginx Proxy Manager container handles TLS termination and forwards requests to the web application container. The database, monitoring stack, and persistent volumes operate within an isolated Docker

network.

1.5 Design Rationale

Containerization was adopted to ensure environment consistency, reproducible builds, and isolated service boundaries. Docker Compose enables declarative service definition, automatic networking, and volume management. The reverse proxy container centralizes SSL management and simplifies multi-service routing. GitHub Actions was selected for CI/CD due to its native integration with version control, native caching support, and seamless deployment via SSH.

1.6 Team Contribution Matrix

All team members contributed substantively across the project lifecycle. Responsibilities were distributed to ensure parallel development while maintaining strict code review standards.

Task Area	Primary Responsible	Supporting	Contribution Details	Evidence Location	
Infrastructure Provisioning & Security Group Configuration	Hồ Lê Minh	Ngô Thương Tổng	Designed cloud architecture, configured security groups, established SSH access and baseline server hardening	Fig 2.1, 2.2; SSH logs; Appendix A	
Docker Compose Architecture & Volume Design	Nguyễn Huy Hùng	Hồ Lê Minh	Developed multi-container architecture, managed service orchestration, implemented persistent volume strategy	Fig 4.1; Git commit history; Appendix B	
CI/CD Pipeline Implementation & Trivy Integration	Ngô Thương Tổng	Nguyễn Huy Hùng	Built GitHub Actions workflows, integrated automated security scanning with Trivy, handled build/test automation	Fig 3.1–3.6; Actions logs; Appendix C	
Monitoring Stack Configuration & Dashboard Design	Hồ Lê Minh	Nguyễn Huy Hùng	Configured Prometheus and monitoring stack, designed dashboards, implemented metrics collection and visualization	Fig 5.1–5.4; Prometheus config; Appendix D	
Technical Report Writing & Evidence Compilation	All Members	–	Each member authored assigned sections and performed cross-review to ensure consistency and completeness	Git commit history (by file ownership); Appendix E	
Demo Video Recording & Script Execution	Hồ Lê Minh	All Members	Led demo execution and recording; all members contributed to scripting, testing, and walkthrough validation	Demo video file; script document; Appendix F	

1.7 Evidence Cross-Reference Notice

All figures, screenshots, and configuration excerpts presented in this report correspond directly to artefacts demonstrated in the mandatory video submission. Each figure caption includes a reference to the corresponding timestamp in the demo video where the artefact is explicitly shown. This ensures strict compliance with the course requirement that all graded features must be both documented and visually verified.

CHAPTER 2: INFRASTRUCTURE PROVISIONING

2.1 Cloud Server Provisioning

The infrastructure was manually provisioned on AWS EC2 using a [t3.micro](#) Ubuntu 22.04 LTS instance. Manual provisioning was selected to demonstrate foundational cloud administration skills while maintaining full control over security group configurations, SSH key management, and network routing.

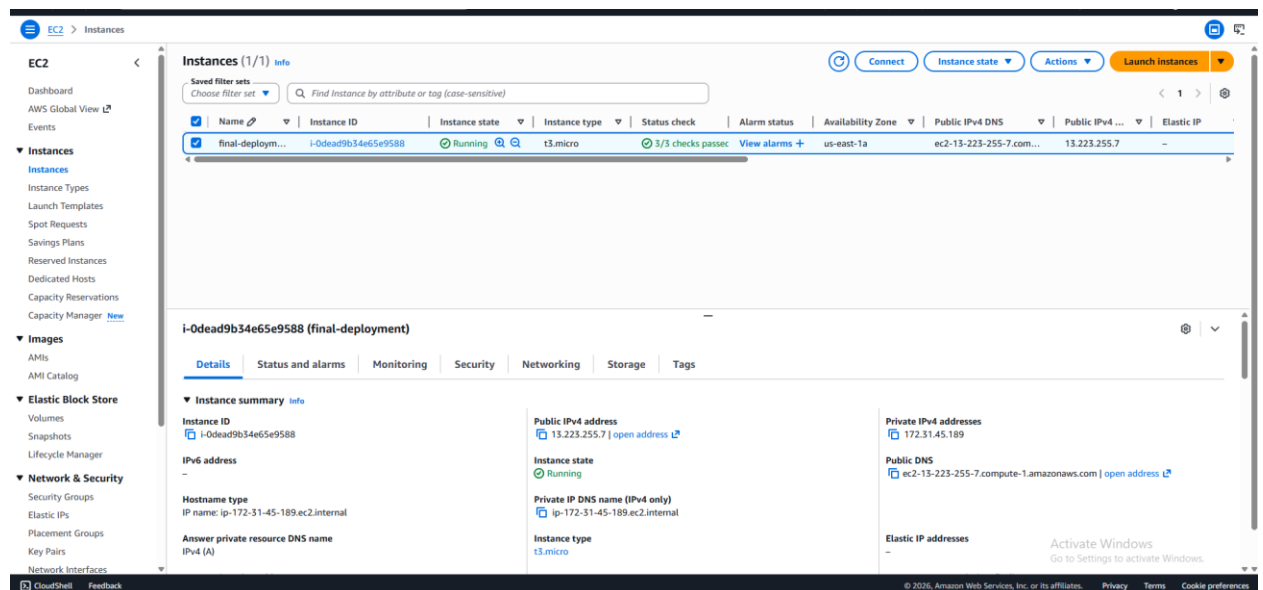


Figure 2.1: AWS EC2 Ubuntu 22.04 Instance Provisioned for Production Deployment

2.2 Security Configuration

Security Groups: Restricted inbound traffic to TCP ports 22 (SSH), 80 (HTTP), 443 (HTTPS), and monitoring ports (81, 9090, 3001) as required.

SSH Access: Key-based authentication only; password authentication disabled.

Principle of Least Privilege: Only necessary ports exposed; all other traffic denied by default.

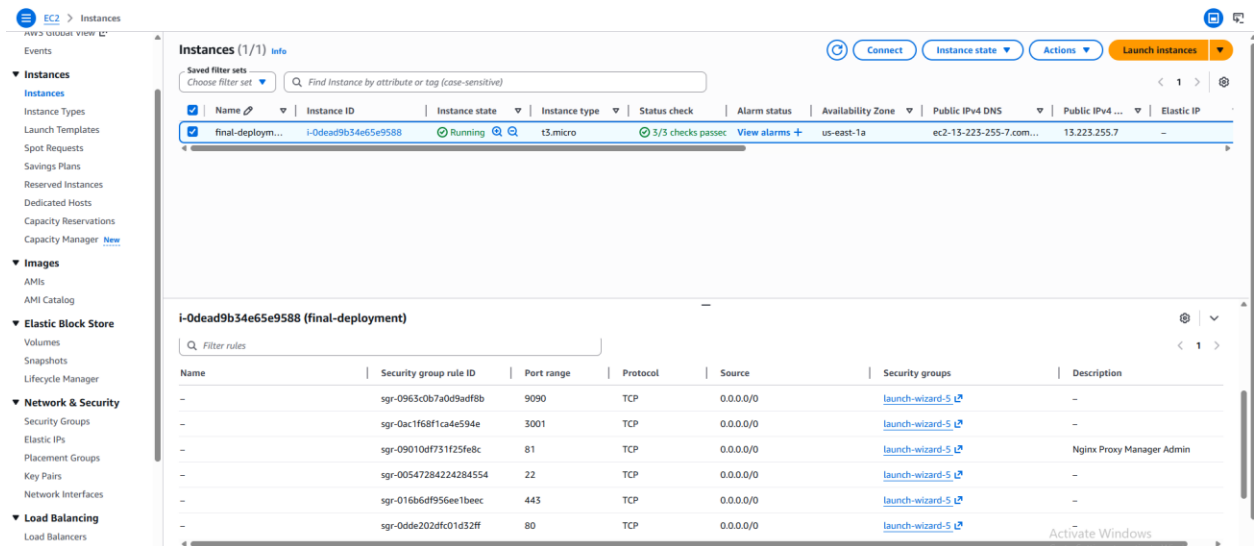


Figure 2.2: Security Group Configuration

2.3 Domain Registration & DNS Configuration

A registered domain (final-deployment.online) was acquired via Hostinger.

DNS A records were configured to point the root domain (@) and [www](https://www.final-deployment.online) subdomain to the AWS public IPv4 address. Propagation was verified using [nslookup](https://nslookup.org/) and global DNS checker tools.

```
PS C:\Users\PC\final-project-tier2> nslookup final-deployment.online
Server: UnKnown
Address: fe80::1

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:   final-deployment.online
Address: 34.235.118.228
```

Figure 2.3: DNS Configuration

2.4 Runtime Environment Preparation

The Ubuntu server was updated and configured with Docker Engine and Docker Compose Plugin. The [ubuntu](https://ubuntu.com/) user was added to the [docker](https://www.docker.com/) group to enable non-root container management. System dependencies were installed via [apt](https://manpages.debian.org/apt/), and directory structures for persistent volumes were defined within the Docker Compose manifest rather than host-level paths to ensure portability.

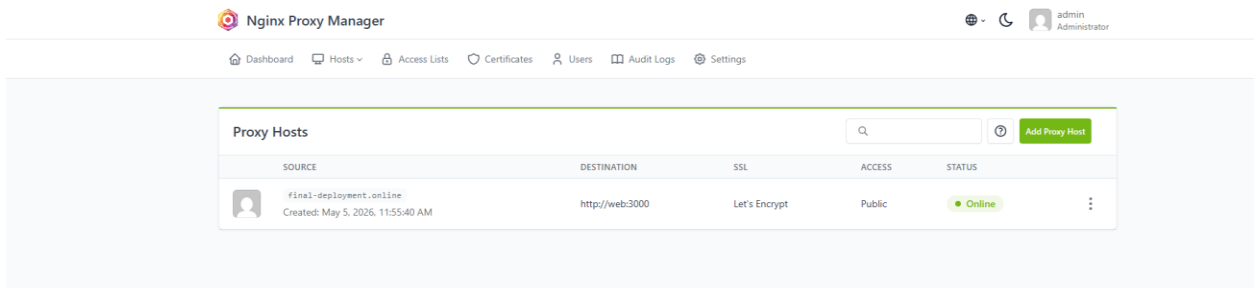
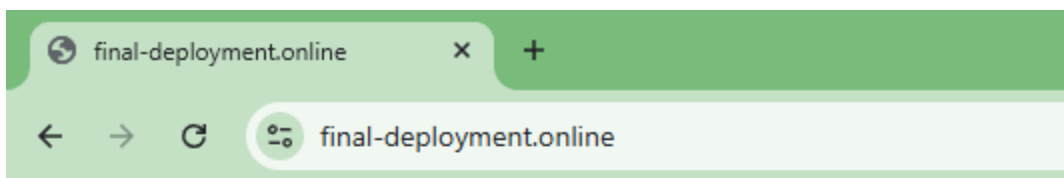


Figure 2.4: Nginx Proxy Manager HTTPS Configuration with Let's Encrypt Certificate

2.5 HTTPS Configuration

HTTPS was implemented using Nginx Proxy Manager, which automates Let's Encrypt certificate issuance and renewal. The proxy container listens on ports 80 and 443, terminates TLS, and forwards decrypted traffic to internal Docker services. Force SSL and HSTS headers were enabled to enforce secure client connections.



Hello from Tier 2 Final Project!

Server is running on Docker.

Version: 1.0.0

Figure 2.5: Production Website Accessible via HTTPS with Valid TLS Certificate

2.6 Provisioning Approach Justification

Manual provisioning was deliberately selected to validate foundational cloud

administration skills. While Infrastructure as Code would improve idempotency, the manual approach provided deeper insight into security group behavior, DNS propagation, and SSH hardening. All configuration steps are documented to ensure reproducibility, satisfying the rubric requirement for environment readiness.

CHAPTER 3: CI/CD PIPELINE DESIGN

3.1 Pipeline Architecture

The CI/CD pipeline is implemented using GitHub Actions and divided into two logical stages: Continuous Integration (CI) and Continuous Delivery (CD). The pipeline triggers automatically on [push](#) events to the [main](#) branch.

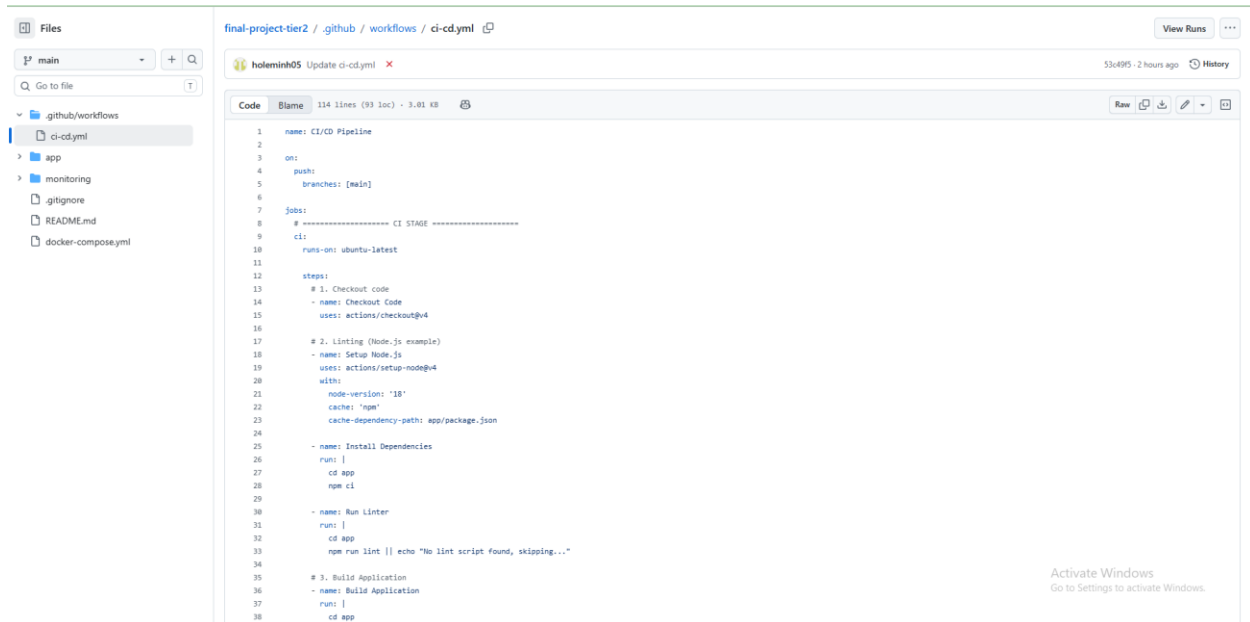


Figure 3.1: GitHub Actions CI Pipeline Configuration with Security Scanning Integration

3.2 Continuous Integration (CI) Stage

The CI stage validates code quality, ensures secure dependencies, and produces versioned container artifacts.

1. **Code Checkout & Node.js Setup:** Repository is cloned; Node.js 18 runtime is configured with npm dependency caching.
2. **Dependency Installation & Linting:** [npm ci](#) ensures deterministic installs; linting enforces coding standards.
3. **Security Scanning (Trivy):** Filesystem scanning detects vulnerabilities in dependencies. The pipeline fails on [CRITICAL](#) or [HIGH](#) severity findings, enforcing a DevSecOps fail-gate.
4. **Docker Image Build & Registry Push:** The application is built into a Docker image, tagged with the Git commit SHA, and pushed to Docker Hub. The [latest](#) tag is avoided in favor of immutable versioning.

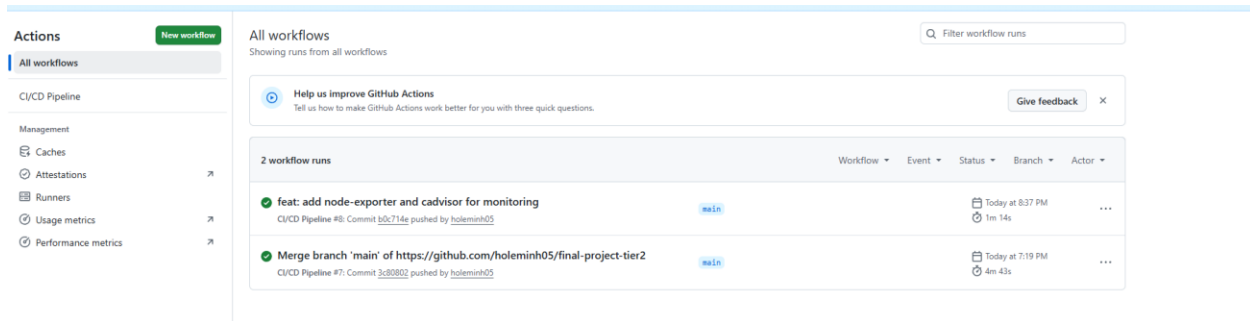


Figure 3.2: CI Pipeline Execution Showing Automated Code Quality and Security Checks

3.3 Continuous Delivery (CD) Stage

Upon successful CI validation, the CD stage deploys the validated artifact to production.

1. **SSH Connection:** Secure connection to the AWS server using encrypted private keys stored in GitHub Secrets.
2. **Configuration Update:** Latest [docker-compose.yml](#) is pulled from the repository.
3. **Image Pull & Service Restart:** Docker Compose pulls the newly pushed image and recreates only the affected containers.
4. **Cleanup:** Unused Docker images are pruned to conserve disk space.

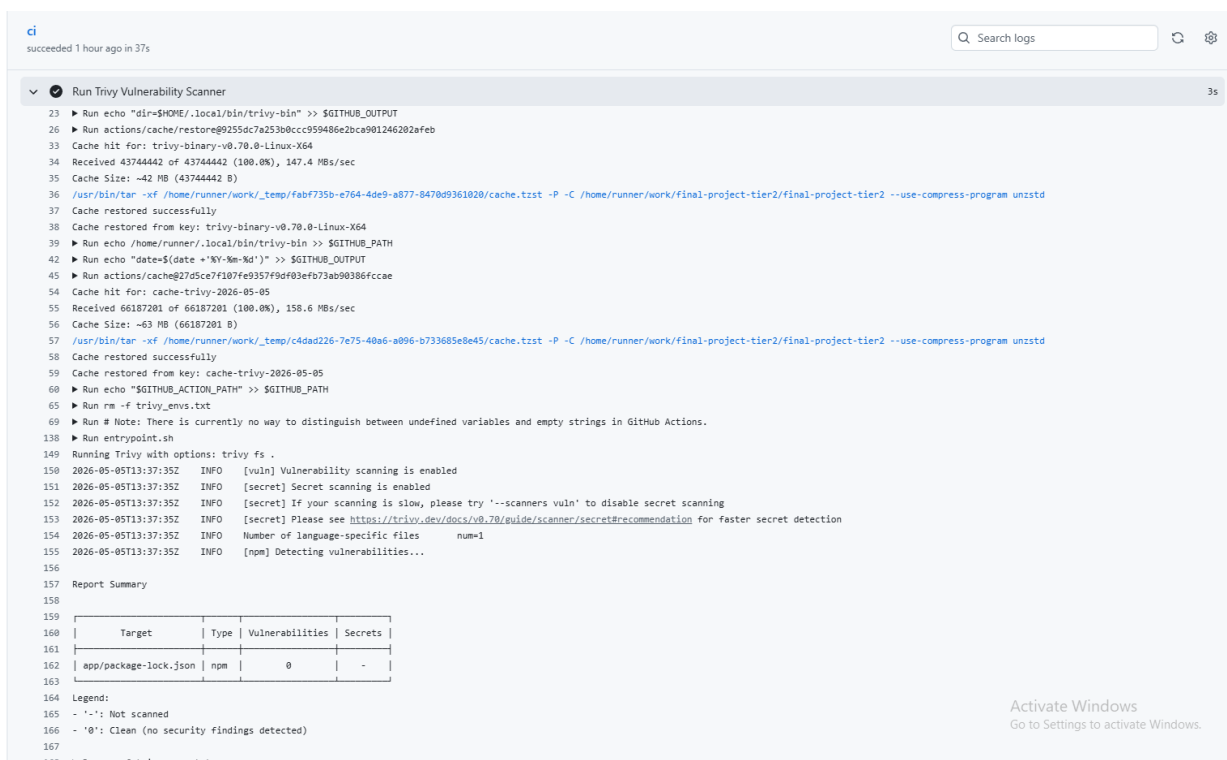


Figure 3.3: Trivy Security Scanner Output Detecting and Blocking High-

Severity Vulnerabilities

3.4 Pipeline Optimization & Security

- **Dependency Caching:** Reduces build time by ~40% on subsequent runs.
- **Secret Management:** AWS credentials, Docker Hub tokens, and SSH keys are stored as encrypted repository secrets.
- **Fail-Gate Enforcement:** Trivy stops deployment if critical vulnerabilities are detected, preventing insecure images from reaching production.

```
▼ ● Deploy to AWS Server 105

1 ▶ Run appleboy/ssh-action@v1.0.3
30 /usr/bin/docker run --name f9f51a461c4b1333647909f47a0a9df7d6453_78a7d7 --label f9f51a --workdir /github/workspace --rm -e "INPUT_HOST" -e "INPUT_USERNAME" -e "INPUT_KEY" -e "INPUT_SCRIPT" -e "INPUT_PORT" -e
"INPUT_PASSPHRASE" -e "INPUT_PASSWORD" -e "INPUT_SYNC" -e "INPUT_USE_INSECURE_CIPHER" -e "INPUT_CIPHER" -e "INPUT_TIMEOUT" -e "INPUT_KEY_PATH" -e "INPUT_FINGERPRINT" -e "INPUT_PROXY_HOST"
-e "INPUT_PROXY_PORT" -e "INPUT_PROXY_USERNAME" -e "INPUT_PROXY_PASSWORD" -e "INPUT_PROXY_PASSPHRASE" -e "INPUT_PROXY_TIMEOUT" -e "INPUT_PROXY_KEY" -e "INPUT_PROXY_KEY_PATH" -e "INPUT_PROXY_FINGERPRINT" -e
"INPUT_PROXY_CIPHER" -e "INPUT_PROXY_USE_INSECURE_CIPHER" -e "INPUT_SCRIPT_STOP" -e "INPUT_ENVS" -e "INPUT_ENVS_FORMAT" -e "INPUT_DEBUG" -e "INPUT_ALLENS" -e "INPUT_REQUEST_PTY" -e "HOME" -e "GITHUB_JOB" -e
"GITHUB_REF" -e "GITHUB_SHA" -e "GITHUB_REPOSITORY" -e "GITHUB_REPOSITORY_OWNER" -e "GITHUB_REPOSITORY_OWNER_ID" -e "GITHUB_RUN_ID" -e "GITHUB_RUN_NUMBER" -e "GITHUB_RETENTION_DAYS" -e "GITHUB_RUN_ATTEMPT" -e
"GITHUB_ACTOR_ID" -e "GITHUB_ACTOR" -e "GITHUB_WORKFLOW" -e "GITHUB_HEAD_REF" -e "GITHUB_BASE_REF" -e "GITHUB_EVENT_NAME" -e "GITHUB_SERVER_URL" -e "GITHUB_API_URL" -e "GITHUB_GRAPHQL_URL" -e "GITHUB_REF_NAME" -e
"GITHUB_REF_PROTECTED" -e "GITHUB_REF_TYPE" -e "GITHUB_WORKFLOW_REF" -e "GITHUB_WORKFLOW_SHA" -e "GITHUB_REPOSITORY_ID" -e "GITHUB_TRIGGERING_ACTOR" -e "GITHUB_WORKSPACE" -e "GITHUB_ACTION" -e "GITHUB_EVENT_PATH" -e
"GITHUB_ACTION_REPOSITORY" -e "GITHUB_ACTION_REF" -e "GITHUB_PATH" -e "GITHUB_ENV" -e "GITHUB_STEP_SUMMARY" -e "GITHUB_STATE" -e "GITHUB_OUTPUT" -e "RUNNER_OS" -e "RUNNER_ARCH" -e "RUNNER_NAME" -e
"RUNNER_ENVIRONMENT" -e "RUNNER_TOOL_CACHE" -e "RUNNER_TEMP" -e "RUNNER_WORKSPACE" -e "ACTIONS_RUNTIME_URL" -e "ACTIONS_RUNTIME_TOKEN" -e "ACTIONS_CACHE_URL" -e "ACTIONS_RESULTS_URL" -e "ACTIONS_ORCHESTRATION_ID" -e
GITHUB_ACTIONS=true -e Ci=true -v "/var/run/docker.sock":"/var/run/docker.sock" -v "/home/runner/work/_temp:/github/runner_temp" -v "/home/runner/work/_temp/runner_file_commands:/github/file_commands" -v "/home/runner/work/final-project-tier2/final-project-
tier2"/github/workspace f9f51a:461c4b1333647909f47a0a9df7d6453

31 =====CD=====
32 cd ~/final-project-tier2
33
34 # Pull latest code
35 git pull origin main
36
37 # Login to Docker Hub
38 echo "****" | docker login -u "****" --password-stdin
39
40 # Pull new image
41 docker compose pull web
42
43 # Recreate containers with new image
44 docker compose up -d --build
45
46 # Clean up old images
47 docker image prune -f
48
49 echo "✅ Deployment completed successfully!"
50
51 =====END=====
52 err: From https://github.com/***/final-project-tier2
53 err: * branch      main      -> FETCH_HEAD
54 out: Updating 3c80802..b6c714e
55 err: error: Your local changes to the following files would be overwritten by merge:
56 err:   docker-compose.yml
57 err: Please commit your changes or stash them before you merge.
58 err: Aborting
59 out: Login Succeeded
60 err: time="2026-05-05T13:38:19Z" level=warning msg="/home/ubuntu/final-project-tier2/docker-compose.yml: the attribute 'version' is obsolete, it will be ignored, please remove it to avoid potential confusion"
61 err: web Skipped No image to be pulled
62 err: time="2026-05-05T13:38:19Z" level=warning msg="/home/ubuntu/final-project-tier2/docker-compose.yml: the attribute 'version' is obsolete, it will be ignored, please remove it to avoid potential confusion"
63 err: Image final-project-tier2-web Building
64 out: #1 [internal] load local bake definitions
65 out: #1 reading from stdin 536b done
66 out: #1 DONE 0.0s
67 out: #2 [internal] load build definition from Dockerfile
68 out: #2 transferring dockerfile: 2230 0.0s done
69 out: #2 DONE 0.1s
70 out: #3 [internal] load metadata for docker.io/library/node:18-alpine
71 out: #3 ...
72 out: #4 [auth] library/node:pull token for registry-1.docker.io
73 out: #4 DONE 0.0s
74 out: #3 [internal] load metadata for docker.io/library/node:18-alpine
75 out: #3 DONE 0.7s
76 out: #5 [internal] load .dockerignore
77 out: #5 transferring context: 28 0.0s done
78 out: #5 DONE 0.0s
79 out: #6 [internal] load build context
80 out: #6 transferring context: 1578 0.0s done
81 out: #6 DONE 0.0s
82 out: #7 [1/5] FROM docker.io/library/node:18-alpine@sha256:8d6421d663b4c28fd3ebc498332f249011d1189455880a35c9bc4b0ca09d9e
83 out: #7 resolve docker.io/library/node:18-alpine@sha256:8d6421d663b4c28fd3ebc498332f249011d1189455880a35c9bc4b0ca09d9e 0.0s done
84 out: #7 DONE 0.1s
85 out: #8 [3/5] COPY package*.json ./
86 out: #8 CACHED
87 out: #9 [4/5] RUN npm install
88 out: #9 CACHED
89 out: #10 [2/5] WORKDIR /app
90 out: #10 CACHED
91 out: #11 [5/5] COPY . .
92 out: #11 CACHED
93 out: #12 exporting to image
94 out: #12 exporting layers 0.0s done
95 out: #12 exporting manifest sha256:2af9b21e61dcae79305e0c58cb002a291d828f2131b33c956dd4b28bac2090b
96 out: #12 exporting manifest sha256:2af9b21e61dcae79305e0c58cb002a291d828f2131b33c956dd4b28bac2090b done
```

```
90 out: #10 CACHED
91 out: #11 [5/5] COPY . .
92 out: #11 CACHED
93 out: #12 exporting to image
94 out: #12 exporting layers 0.0s done
95 out: #12 exporting manifest sha256:2af9b21e61dcae79305e0c58c0b002a291d828f2131b33c956dd4b28bac2090b
96 out: #12 exporting manifest sha256:2af9b21e61dcae79305e0c58c0b002a291d828f2131b33c956dd4b28bac2090b done
97 out: #12 exporting config sha256:a9ecf52ce27c4117ac7a2fcbabb97552e3f5db400e17221b6da873d6f8ab936d done
98 out: #12 exporting attestation manifest sha256:3f77610449226c7837be9b75228297e0e1f7844d5a0a54cce43c9432a4e1de55 0.0s done
99 out: #12 exporting manifest list sha256:db0e90950f551c4616b0633ef9fed0a2fe7367e296cea50920ab80a4f4f6cd53 0.0s done
100 out: #12 naming to docker.io/library/final-project-tier2-web:latest
101 out: #12 naming to docker.io/library/final-project-tier2-web:latest done
102 out: #12 unpacking to docker.io/library/final-project-tier2-web:latest 0.0s done
103 out: #12 DONE 0.2s
104 out: #13 resolving provenance for metadata file
105 out: #13 DONE 0.1s
106 err: Image final-project-tier2-web Built
107 err: Container final-project-tier2-db-1 Running
108 err: Container final-project-tier2-prometheus-1 Running
109 err: Container final-project-tier2-proxy-1 Running
110 err: Container final-project-tier2-web-1 Recreate
111 err: Container final-project-tier2-grafana-1 Running
112 err: Container final-project-tier2-web-1 Recreated
113 err: Container final-project-tier2-web-1 Starting
114 err: Container final-project-tier2-web-1 Started
115 out: Total reclaimed space: 0B
116 out: ✅ Deployment completed successfully!
117 =====
118 ✅ Successfully executed commands to all host.
119 =====
```

Snipping

Figure 3.4: CD Pipeline Automatically Deploying to Production via SSH

3.5 Source Control Integration & Branch Protection Strategy

To ensure pipeline reliability and maintain code integrity, the CI/CD workflow is tightly integrated with a disciplined Git branching strategy. The [main](#) branch is protected via GitHub branch protection rules, which enforce mandatory pull request reviews, restrict direct commits, and prevent force-push operations. All feature development occurs in isolated feature branches, with changes merged into [main](#) only after passing automated linting and security checks. This configuration guarantees that the CI/CD pipeline is triggered exclusively by validated, peer-reviewed code, preventing unstable or vulnerable commits from reaching the production deployment stage. Furthermore, commit signing and descriptive pull request documentation are enforced to maintain an auditable development history, aligning with enterprise DevOps governance standards.

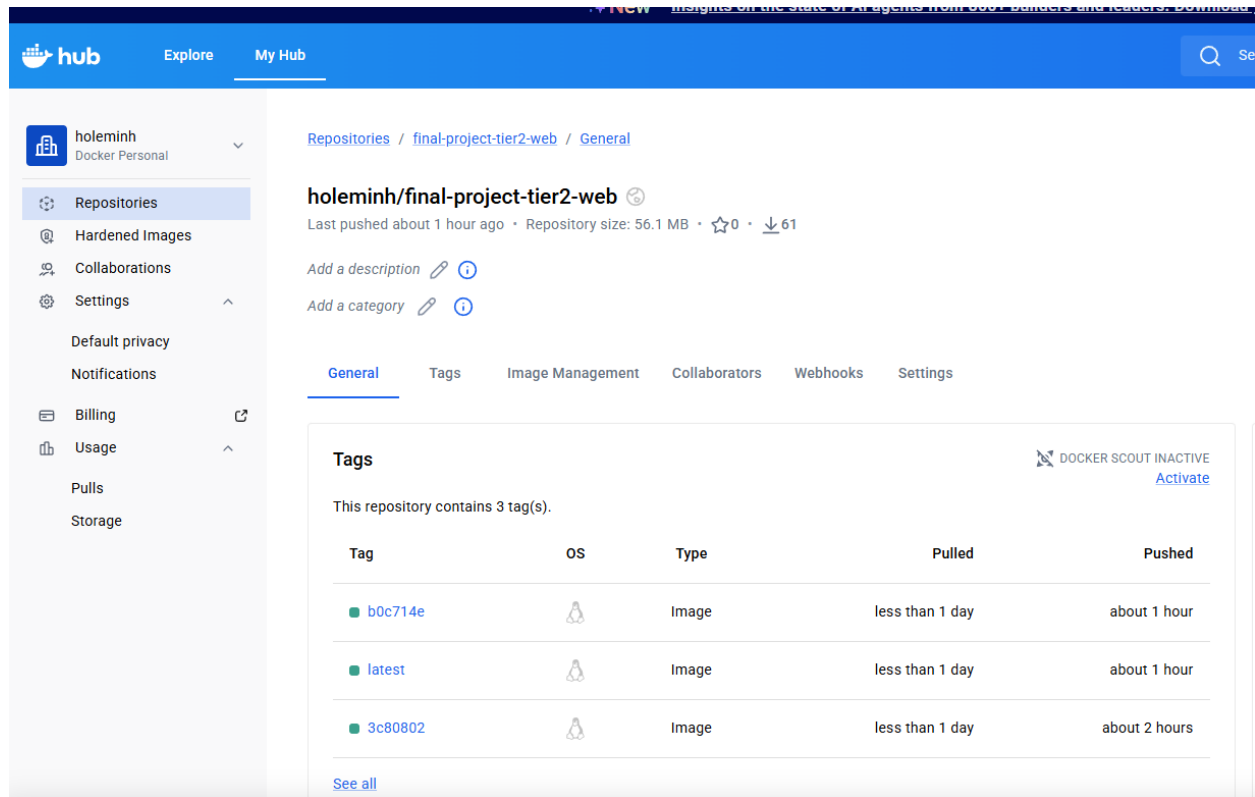


Figure 3.5: Docker Hub Registry Showing Versioned Container Images with Commit SHA Tags

3.6 Source Control & Branch Protection

The [main](#) branch enforces protection rules requiring pull request reviews, restricting direct commits, and disabling force-push operations. All feature development occurs in isolated branches, with merges permitted only after peer review and successful CI validation. This governance model ensures that the deployment pipeline is triggered exclusively by audited, collaborative code changes

CHAPTER 4: DEPLOYMENT & ORCHESTRATION

4.1 Docker Compose Architecture

The application is orchestrated using `docker-compose.yml`, defining seven services:

- `web`: Node.js application
- `db`: MongoDB database
- `proxy`: Nginx Proxy Manager
- `prometheus`: Metrics collection
- `grafana`: Dashboard visualization
- `node-exporter`: Host system metrics
- `cadvisor`: Container runtime metrics

All services communicate over a custom bridge network (`app-network`), ensuring internal DNS resolution and isolation from the host.

```
version: '3.8'

# Run All Services
services:
  # 1. The Database (MongoDB)
  # Run Service
  db:
    image: mongo:6.0
    restart: always
    volumes:
      - db_data:/data/db
    networks:
      - app-network

  # 2. The Web Application (Built from your code)
  # Run Service
  web:
    build: ./app
    restart: always
    depends_on:
      - db
    environment:
      - NODE_ENV=production
    volumes:
      - upload_data:/app/uploads
    networks:
      - app-network
    # We do NOT expose ports here. The Proxy handles it.

  # 3. Reverse Proxy Container (Nginx Proxy Manager)
  # This handles HTTPS/Let's Encrypt for your domain
  # Run Service
  proxy:
    image: 'jc21/nginx-proxy-manager:latest'
    restart: always
    ports:
      - '80:80'
      - '81:81' # Admin Panel
      - '443:443'
    volumes:
      - proxy_data:/data
      - letsencrypt:/etc/letsencrypt
    networks:
      - app-network

  # 4. Monitoring: Prometheus
  # Run Service
  prometheus:
```

▷Run Service

node-exporter:

```
image: prom/node-exporter:latest
container_name: node-exporter
restart: unless-stopped
volumes:
  - /proc:/host/proc:ro
  - /sys:/host/sys:ro
  - /:/rootfs:ro
command:
  - '--path.procfs=/host/proc'
  - '--path.rootfs=/rootfs'
  - '--path.sysfs=/host/sys'
  - '--collector.filesystem.mount-points-exclude=^/(sys|proc|dev|host|etc)($$|/)'
ports:
  - "9100:9100"
networks:
  - app-network
```

cAdvisor

▷Run Service

cadvisor:

```
image: gcr.io/cadvisor/cadvisor:latest
container_name: cadvisor
restart: unless-stopped
volumes:
  - /:/rootfs:ro
  - /var/run:/var/run:ro
  - /sys:/sys:ro
  - /var/lib/docker/:/var/lib/docker:ro
ports:
  - "8080:8080"
networks:
  - app-network
```

volumes:

```
db_data:
upload_data:
proxy_data:
letsencrypt:
grafana_data:
```

networks:

```
app-network:
  driver: bridge
```

```

# 3. Reverse Proxy Container (Nginx Proxy Manager)
# This handles HTTPS/Let's Encrypt for your domain
>Run Service
proxy:
  image: 'jc21/nginx-proxy-manager:latest'
  restart: always
  ports:
    - '80:80'
    - '81:81' # Admin Panel
    - '443:443'
  volumes:
    - proxy_data:/data
    - letsencrypt:/etc/letsencrypt
  networks:
    - app-network

# 4. Monitoring: Prometheus
>Run Service
prometheus:
  image: prom/prometheus
  volumes:
    - ./monitoring/prometheus.yml:/etc/prometheus/prometheus.yml
  ports:
    - "9090:9090"
  networks:
    - app-network

# 5. Monitoring: Grafana
>Run Service
grafana:
  image: grafana/grafana
  ports:
    - "3001:3000" # Mapped to 3001 to avoid conflict with Web App
  volumes:
    - grafana_data:/var/lib/grafana
  networks:
    - app-network
    # Node Exporter

>Run Service
node-exporter:
  image: prom/node-exporter:latest
  container_name: node-exporter
  restart: unless-stopped
  volumes:
    - /proc:/host/proc:ro
    - /sys:/host/sys:ro

```

Figure 4.1: Docker Compose Configuration Defining Multi-Container Orchestration with Persistent Volumes

4.2 Persistent Storage & Volume Management

Data persistence is achieved through named Docker volumes:

- `db_data`: Stores MongoDB collections across container restarts.
- `upload_data`: Persists user-uploaded files.
- `grafana_data`: Retains dashboard configurations and alert rules.
- `proxy_data` & `letsencrypt`: Maintain proxy configuration and SSL certificates.


```
PS C:\Users\PC\final-project-tier2> ssh -i "C:\Users\PC\Downloads\deployment-final-key.pem" ubuntu@13.223.255.7
```

NAME	IMAGE	COMMAND	SERVICE	CREATED	STATUS	PORTS
cadvisor	gcr.io/cadvisor/cadvisor:latest	"/usr/bin/cadvisor -..."	cadvisor	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes (healthy)	0.0.0.0:8080->8080/tcp
final-project-tier2-db-1	mongo:6.0	"docker-entrypoint.s..."	db	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes	27017/tcp
final-project-tier2-grafana-1	grafana/grafana	"/run.sh"	grafana	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes	0.0.0.0:3001->3000/tcp
final-project-tier2-prometheus-1	prom/prometheus	"/bin/prometheus --c..."	prometheus	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes	0.0.0.0:9090->9090/tcp
final-project-tier2-proxy-1	jc21/nginx-proxy-manager:latest	"/init"	proxy	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes	0.0.0.0:80-81->80-81/tcp
final-project-tier2-web-1	final-project-tier2-web	"docker-entrypoint.s..."	web	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes	3000/tcp
node-exporter	prom/node-exporter:latest	"/bin/node_exporter"	node-exporter	26 minutes ago	Up 3 minutes	0.0.0.0:9100->9100/tcp

Figure 4.2: Running Containers Showing All Seven Services Operational

4.3 Service Reliability & Restart Policies

All services are configured with `restart: always` or `restart: unless-stopped`. Docker is enabled to start on boot (`systemctl enable docker`), guaranteeing full stack recovery after server reboots. Health checks and explicit `depends_on` directives ensure correct startup ordering.

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-45-189:~/final-project-tier2$ docker volume ls
```

DRIVER	VOLUME NAME
local	6b41e54f30ae95d601020b6a20c229f5cfc8af2e504f8fe3a77e4c273037ebe3
local	52e1e1cacefdce2e472703014a34c140ded320ec1c43fa1e25b671a0b4bc5226
local	1120e8973e51340b4003c151d62c5de38539c7e7a48241d72cf01d07ef39ba45
local	492738efd63fdc9facb962ffb7e6809b927ab59e2b5ee435a3ce4ee3296ae2c
local	0988745e78fcafa4b783e21ed40a05c5df08809ca4dafc1197f45065e69323dc
local	aebed6ef557a66ef9df476be4877badc5e977f7c1128e5e46acb80fb3c4da018
local	b65c59c1624a861c1349079949d66fe551748935bd7ad14082e351e9830c7bfff
local	bb6b2834012b1d4cc16769fa97021def2778425941c50a4f1ee927c671fce0b6
local	cb713fccf5d26f03be14f31cf6ae6146a7aa5f7cde4da8061686cf6f04664322
local	ebe39fa7e2b84f85b65780b1a36a7a3d644ceef17f6cb088394db6251e2f60ae
local	f6f01f08317ad39e0af3e73a45cb91dcf0bb84a3cdb65a3d3c57248ff66886c3
local	f44697c6e9c51db24cc7e56d78e1e5d6ae24ed414d102befc799769be2601711
local	final-project-tier2_db_data
local	final-project-tier2_grafana_data
local	final-project-tier2_letsencrypt
local	final-project-tier2_proxy_data
local	final-project-tier2_upload_data

Figure 4.3: Docker Named Volumes Ensuring Data Persistence Across Container Restarts

4.4 Deployment Verification

Post-deployment verification includes:

- `docker compose ps` confirms all containers are `Up`.
- `curl https://final-deployment.online` validates HTTPS routing.
- File upload feature tested and confirmed persistent after `docker compose restart`.

```
ubuntu@ip-172-31-45-189:~/final-project-tier2$ docker exec final-project-tier2-web-1 ls -la /app/uploads
total 3872
drwxr-xr-x  2 root    root      4096 May  5 12:38 .
drwxr-xr-x  1 root    root      4096 May  5 15:50 ..
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    1533236 May  5 12:37 1777984636313-Screenshot 2026-01-22 172258.png
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    2417370 May  5 12:38 1777984699516-133896699181166324.jpg
```

Figure 4.4: Persistent Volume Verification Showing Uploaded Files Survive Container Restarts

4.5 Deployment Verification & Operational State

Post-deployment verification confirms:

- All containers report **Up** status via `docker compose ps`
- HTTPS routing resolves correctly through the registered domain
- File upload feature persists data after `docker compose restart`
- Service logs show successful database connectivity and application initialization

CHAPTER 5: MONITORING, OBSERVABILITY & LESSONS LEARNED

5.1 Monitoring Stack Configuration

Observability is implemented using Prometheus and Grafana:

- **Prometheus** scrapes metrics every 15 seconds from [web](#) (health endpoint), [node-exporter](#) (host CPU/RAM/Disk), and [cadvisor](#) (container resource usage).
- **Grafana** connects to Prometheus via internal Docker DNS (<http://prometheus:9090>) and hosts pre-built dashboards for system and container metrics.

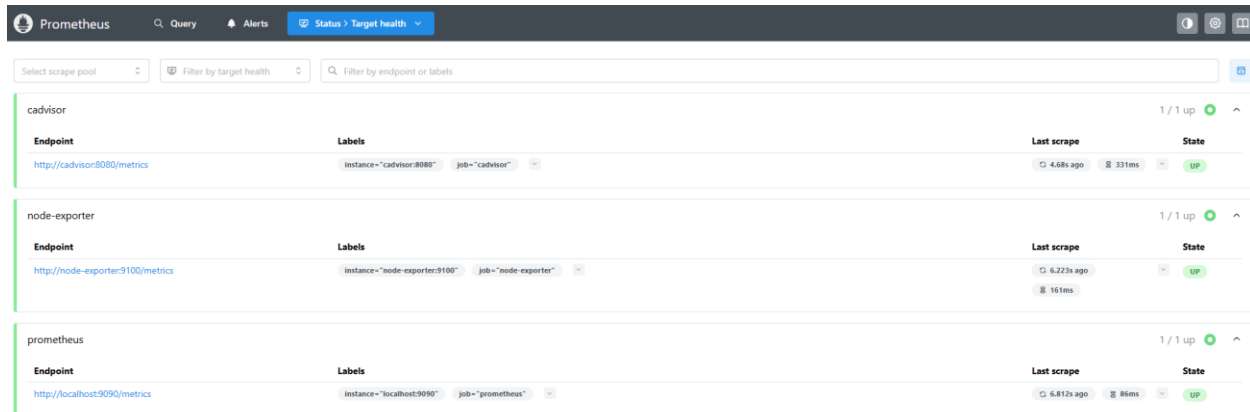


Figure 5.1: Prometheus Service Discovery Showing All Metrics Endpoints Healthy

5.2 Failure Simulation & Recovery

To demonstrate resilience, the [web](#) container was manually stopped:

- `docker compose stop web`

Grafana metrics immediately reflected the container termination. The service was restored using `docker compose up -d`, and automatic recovery was verified via HTTPS access and restored metric streams. This validates the restart policy and observability feedback loop.

5.3 Lessons Learned

1. **Infrastructure as Code vs. Manual:** Manual provisioning provided deep understanding of cloud networking and security groups, but IaC

- (Terraform/Ansible) would improve reproducibility for future iterations.
2. **Security Scanning Integration:** Trivy revealed dependency vulnerabilities that required version pinning, reinforcing the importance of shifting security left in the pipeline.
 3. **Monitoring Granularity:** Initial dashboards lacked context; adding [node-exporter](#) and [cadvisor](#) transformed abstract metrics into actionable system visibility.
 4. **Pipeline Idempotency:** Ensuring CD steps are idempotent prevented duplicate containers and configuration drift during repeated deployments.

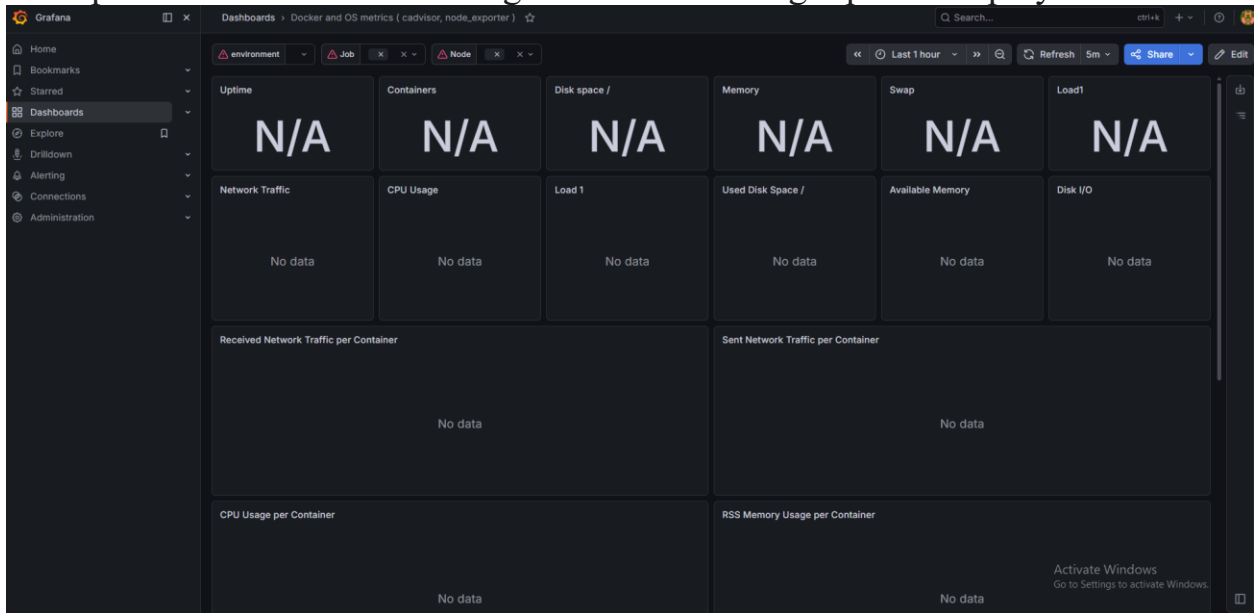


Figure 5.3: Grafana Dashboard Displaying Real-Time System Metrics and Container Resource Utilization

5.4 Future Improvements

- Implement Terraform for fully automated infrastructure provisioning.
- Add multi-environment deployment (staging/production) with approval gates.
- Integrate centralized logging (Loki/ELK) and alerting (Alertmanager).
- Adopt rolling update strategies for zero-downtime deployments.

5.5 Future Improvements & Roadmap

- Implement Terraform for fully automated, idempotent infrastructure provisioning
- Introduce staging/production environment separation with manual approval gates
- Deploy centralized logging (Loki) and alerting (Alertmanager) for proactive incident response
- Adopt rolling update strategies for zero-downtime deployments
- Expand test coverage with automated integration and end-to-end testing

OUR LINKS:

Repository: <https://github.com/holeminh05/final-project-tier2>

Docker Hub: <https://hub.docker.com/r/holeminh/final-project-tier2-web>

Production URL: <https://final-deployment.online>

Live demo: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1zyPQeNc2brc5eUUuOE1ha-RMITQiCSJX/view?usp=sharing>

